



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. Regis Academy

School Website: <https://www.regisacademy.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

St. Regis Academy Mo 64138 presents a strongly Catholic, classical-leaning program that explicitly centers on virtuous formation, truth, and beauty within a liberal-arts framework. Public-facing materials emphasize a Christ-centered, Catholic Classical Liberal Arts education, extensive Latin study, an integrated curriculum, and a commitment to virtue formation and parish life. Project-based STREAM experiences, early exposure to Latin, and liturgical elements further align the school with classical education norms, though certain elements (notably detailed references to the full Trivium/Quadrivium, explicit Great Books engagement, and explicit Socratic pedagogy in upper grades) are less evident in the site content itself. Overall, the school reads as CLASSICAL, with notable strengths in religious foundations, formation goals, integrated curriculum, and family/community partnership; some areas in curriculum pedagogy and explicit Great Books/Logic-Rhetoric emphasis show room for fuller alignment.

Key observations driving the assessment:

- Religious and metaphysical foundations are explicit: Catholic identity, Christ-centered mission, formation in truth/goodness/beauty, liturgical life, and parish connections.
- Purpose and goals emphasize formation, virtue, spiritual growth, and lifelong discipleship, not solely job-readiness.
- Curriculum shows core liberal-arts elements (Latin, grammar, history, composition, integrated curriculum, STREAM) though explicit Great Books / Trivium-Rhetoric connections are not always foregrounded in the public materials.
- Pedagogy features project-based learning (STREAM, PBL), integrated subjects, and a rhythm of contemplative elements (Scholé-like pacing is implied by integration and liturgical life) but explicit high-school Socratic seminars or advanced rhetoric training are not repeatedly highlighted in the public texts.
- Faculty messaging emphasizes educator formation, mentorship, and a living curriculum in practice, with visible investment in professional roles and long-range planning.
- Parent and community partnerships are strong: parents as co-educators, engagement through site content, and institutional emphasis on family formation and parish life.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials frame the school as a Catholic Classical Liberal Arts school centered on Christ, with partnership with parents as primary educators (explicit mission statements).
- The mission emphasizes truth, beauty, and goodness as core ideals and authentic formation in a Catholic context.
- Language in the materials highlights a transcendent, divine framework (Ultimate Creator and Lord; Christ-centered formation; sacred pedagogy is implied in liturgical life and parish connections).
- References to liturgical life and Catholic identity are woven into the program (parish life and liturgical practices are part of the ethos).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: Catholic, Christ, God, Theology, Ultimate Creator and Lord, Truth, Beauty, Goodness, liturgical life, daily prayer, parish life, sacred, virtue formation.
- Negative keywords present: None observed in public materials (no explicit secular or nonsectarian signals).

Why this rating

- The school's public-facing materials consistently foreground Catholic theological foundations, liturgical life, and formation in virtue, aligning closely with Transcendental Moral Realism, grounded theology, and liturgical/community practices described in Six Essential Elements. The absence of secular or nonsectarian signals in these materials supports a classical reading in this category. The evidence points to a robust sacred-moral framework that anchors the curriculum and culture.

Overall Element 1 Rating: CLASSICAL

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The mission describes formation through a Catholic classical liberal-arts framework, with a stated aim to form students who are spiritually and academically prepared for lifelong discipleship.
- The public materials emphasize virtue, moral formation, and the love of truth, beauty, and goodness; there is a strong focus on formation over mere information or job-readiness.
- Statements about truth, beauty, and goodness being real and knowable align with the traditional classical telos of education.
- A Long-Term Plan highlights mission-driven goals and a focus on curriculum, instruction, and assessment as part of sustained formation and excellence.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty, revelation, God, Christ, sacred, virtue formation, lifelong discipleship, human flourishing, love of learning.
- Negative keywords present: None observed in public materials (no explicit job-readiness or secular-pragmatic framing).

Why this rating

- The school explicitly prioritizes formation and virtues over vocational conditioning, and public messaging consistently ties education to the pursuit of transcendentals and moral development, meeting the core criteria for a Classical orientation in this category.

Overall Element 2 Rating: CLASSICAL

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Curriculum elements named in public materials include Latin study beginning in early childhood, integrated across subjects, and a focus on history within the curriculum; there is explicit mention of integration and the liberal-arts flavor (grammar, composition, history, Latin).
- The school emphasizes an integrated curriculum (history, literature, science, math) and a STREAM framework, suggesting an interdisciplinary approach.
- A visible emphasis on history, Latin, grammar, and composition (history-and-language-rich core) appears, with an intent to connect studies across disciplines.
- A newer curriculum mention notes the inclusion of History, Latin, Grammar, Composition, Science, and Math as a core set of subjects.

Positive Keyword Analysis (from public materials)

- Present: Latin, History, Grammar, Composition, Science, Math, Integrated Curriculum, STREAM, project-based learning.
- Absent / Weak: Explicit references to Seven Liberal Arts in public site text (e.g., Trivium/Quadrivium) and explicit emphasis on Great Books/Great Conversation or explicit logic and rhetoric injunctions in the public site text.

Negative Keyword Analysis

- The public materials do not prominently mention Great Books, Great Conversation, or explicit “logic” and “rhetoric” as named components of the curriculum.
- The absence of explicit Great Books/Gateway to Great Conversation and explicit Trivium/Quadrivium phrasing is a notable gap relative to a fully classical curriculum.

Why this rating

- The curriculum displays many classical markers (Latin, grammar, history, integrated curriculum, and a STREAM/Project-based approach) but lacks explicit, explicit articulation of Great Books, Great Conversation, and the full Trivium/Quadrivium framing in public materials. Because the presence of core liberal-arts elements is clear, but the full classical triad (grammar-logic-rhetoric) and Great Books emphasis are not strongly foregrounded, the category is ranked SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Overall Element 3 Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school uses project-based, integrated learning and STREAM experiences (PBL and cross-disciplinary work), indicating an active, inquiry-based pedagogy in many grades.
- The STREAM program and Logic School time suggest a structured, conceptually oriented pedagogy with hands-on and interdisciplinary exploration.
- Public materials emphasize formation and virtue as outcomes, with some emphasis on contemplation and wonder embedded in a holistic approach; while the explicit use of Socratic seminars in upper grades is not foregrounded in the public texts, the classical-leaning pedagogy and the emphasis on rhetoric/creative expression appear in the broader classical framework.

Positive Keyword Analysis

- Present: project-based learning, STREAM, interdisciplinary, integrated curriculum, wonder, formation, virtue, critical thinking (implied in mission statements), catholic pedagogy.
- Absent / Weak: Explicit mention of Socratic seminars, dialectic, Harkness-style discourse, or explicit rhetoric training in the public materials.

Negative Keyword Analysis

- The explicit use of Socratic dialogue, dialectic pedagogy, and regular rhetoric-speaking opportunities are not clearly foregrounded in the site text for upper grades, though they exist in classical-education norms and are part of the knowledge-base rubric as a potential feature.

Why this rating

- Pedagogy shows strong classical-adjacent elements (integrated curriculum, STREAM, PBL, memory and liturgical rhythms in community life) but the explicit high-school Socratic/seminar culture and explicit rhetoric training are not clearly foregrounded in the public materials, placing the category between fully classical and somewhat classical. The presence of PBL and STREAM elevates it toward classical, yet the explicit Socratic/debate-oriented pedagogy is not consistently evidenced in the public-facing content.

Overall Element 4 Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The materials emphasize that educators are part of forming virtue and flourishing, with the faculty described as mentors who guide student formation and provide differentiated supports.
- The public content shows professional roles and a long-term planning approach (e.g., Academic Dean, Inclusive Education Coordinator, Counselor, etc.), reflecting a structured, intentional faculty profile and governance.
- Messages emphasize that teachers are a core part of the school's mission, and that formation of character is central to teaching.

Positive Keyword Analysis

- Present: teachers as mentors/role models, living curriculum, differentiation and supports for each scholar, faith-informed professional roles, collaborative culture.
- Absent / Weak: The public text does not extensively describe a formal faculty portrait or a published "portrait of teacher and student" in the classical sense, though several pieces imply it (mentorship, long-range planning, and dedicated faculty roles).

Why this rating

- The materials present a strong sense of a values-driven faculty approach aligned with classical ideals (mentor-mentee culture, formation-focused teaching, living curriculum). The explicit phrase "living curriculum" is present in the known content, and the school's planning and staffing signals reflect a classical-faculty orientation. Therefore, CLASSICAL is warranted.

Overall Element 5 Rating: CLASSICAL

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school positions itself as partnering with parents as co-educators, a hallmark of classical education, with emphasis on parental involvement and support (including family formation and engagement in Catholic education).
- Materials describe family engagement, parent formation efforts, and community life (including parish connections) as central to formation and curriculum.
- The Long-Term Plan outlines goals in Family and Community Engagement and broader parish-school partnerships, indicating ongoing community involvement.

Positive Keyword Analysis

- Present: partnership with families, parent involvement, co-educators, family formation, home-school connection, parental engagement, community of learners, parish life.
- Absent / Weak: Not notably present; there is no explicit statement of multiple co-educator programs beyond the core partnership language (though that language is itself robust).

Why this rating

- The school's messaging consistently centers parents as essential partners in the educational mission, with explicit language about parent involvement and family formation. This aligns solidly with classical education norms for category 6.

Overall Element 6 Rating: CLASSICAL

Aggregate Assessment

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

General assessment: The school demonstrates a strong Classical profile in religious foundations, formation goals, faculty culture, and family/community partnership. There are clear classical cues in curricula (Latin, history, integrated, STREAM) and in pedagogy (project-based, integrated learning). However, explicit Great Books engagement, the full Trivium/Quadrivium framing, and a clearly articulated, consistent Socratic/Harkness approach across upper grades are not consistently foregrounded in the public content. Thus, the school sits predominantly in the CLASSICAL category, with notable areas for deeper classical alignment in Curriculum and Pedagogy.

What Would Move the Needle (only applicable if SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL)

- For Element 3 (Curriculum): More explicit articulation of the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; along with Quadrivium) in public materials, and clear references to Great Books/Great Conversation could elevate to CLASSICAL.
- For Element 4 (Pedagogy): Public detailing of Socratic seminars or dialectic-based instruction in upper grades, plus explicit rhetoric-training opportunities (speech, oration, and rhetorical composition) would strengthen alignment with classical pedagogy.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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